

Topic 2: Writing Effective Prompts for Content

2.1 The Content Prompt Formula

- Audience: who will read this? Their knowledge level, role, and what they care about
- Goal: what should the reader think, feel, or do after reading?
- Format: blog article, email, tweet thread, ad copy, script, bullet list, or structured outline
- Tone: formal, casual, authoritative, empathetic, humorous, urgent, or persuasive
- Length: word count or number of paragraphs / bullets / sections
- Constraints: must-include topics, must-avoid topics, keywords to use, things to not mention

General content prompt template:

```
Write a [FORMAT] for [AUDIENCE].  
Goal: [WHAT THE READER SHOULD DO / THINK / FEEL].  
Tone: [TONE].  
Length: [WORD COUNT OR STRUCTURE].  
Must include: [KEY POINTS OR SECTIONS].  
Do not include: [EXCLUSIONS].  
Brand voice: [DESCRIBE OR PASTE WRITING SAMPLE].
```

2.2 Providing Your Brand Voice

- Paste writing samples: 'Here are 3 examples of our published writing. Match this style and voice exactly.'
- Describe adjectives: 'Our brand voice is: bold, approachable, jargon-free, slightly witty'
- Define what to avoid: 'Never use corporate buzzwords, passive voice, or cliches like synergy or leverage'
- Create a reusable brand voice prompt you paste at the start of every content session
- The more specific examples you provide, the more accurately AI can match your actual voice

2.3 Iterative Refinement

- Generate -> evaluate -> refine across multiple turns rather than expecting perfection on the first prompt
- Common follow-up refinements: 'Make the opening hook stronger', 'Cut this by 30%', 'Add a clear CTA at the end'
- Ask for multiple options: 'Give me 5 different headline options for this piece'
- Style adjustments: 'Rewrite the second paragraph in a more conversational tone'
- Structure changes: 'Convert this prose into a numbered step-by-step list'

2.4 Adding the Human Element

- Insert personal anecdotes, specific data, and original opinions that AI cannot generate on your behalf
 - Replace generic AI examples with real company-specific or industry-specific examples
 - Add a unique angle or fresh perspective that goes beyond what a general summary would provide
 - Final test: read the piece aloud -- any section that sounds robotic or generic needs a human rewrite
 - Strong AI-assisted content is indistinguishable from great human writing because a human shaped it throughout
-